

1 **HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES - FLOOR VERSION**

2 STATE OF OKLAHOMA

3 2nd Session of the 60th Legislature (2026)

4 ENGROSSED SENATE
5 BILL NO. 330

By: Murdock of the Senate

and

Moore of the House

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9 An Act relating to the Oklahoma State University
10 Veterinary Medicine Authority; defining terms;
11 authorizing the Authority to conduct study on elk
12 populations in this state; requiring a plan to be
13 established by certain date; specifying parameters of
14 study; requiring a management plan to be created at
15 conclusion of study; allowing the Authority to
16 coordinate with other agencies and experts; providing
17 for codification; providing an effective date; and
18 declaring an emergency.

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22 BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

23 SECTION 1. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified
24 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 4024 of Title 2, unless there is
25 created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

26 A. For the purposes of this section:

27 1. "Authority" means the Oklahoma State University Veterinary
28 Medicine Authority;

29 2. "Management plan" means a document developed by the Oklahoma
30 State University Veterinary Medicine Authority based on the findings

1 of the study pursuant to this section that outlines the recommended
2 actions for the conservation and management of elk populations in
3 this state; and

4 3. "Study zone" means the Special Northwest Zone that
5 encompasses all private lands in Woodward, Dewey, and Ellis
6 counties, and a portion of Roger Mills County north of State
7 Highways 33 and 47 to the north county line and west to the state
8 border and east to the county line.

9 B. No later than November 1, 2026, the Oklahoma State
10 University Veterinary Medicine Authority in cooperation with the
11 Oklahoma State University College of Veterinary Medicine shall
12 establish a plan and outline for a comprehensive study of the elk
13 populations within the Special Northwest Zone. This study shall
14 assess current population levels, trends, and habitat usage, and
15 develop science-based management recommendations aimed at ensuring
16 the long-term sustainability of elk populations and the health of
17 the ecosystem. The study shall include, but not be limited to, the
18 following program characteristics:

19 1. The current elk population size, distribution, and density
20 within the study zone;

21 2. The health and genetic diversity of the elk population,
22 including disease monitoring and signs of inbreeding, or other
23 health concerns; and
24

1 3. The effectiveness and impact of current elk population
2 management strategies, including hunting, predation control, and
3 habitat management.

4 Recommendations from the study shall be assessed and compiled in
5 a management plan for the conservation and management of elk
6 populations within the study zone and shall be made available on the
7 Authority's website.

8 C. The Authority may coordinate with other relevant state and
9 federal agencies to effectuate the provisions of this section. Such
10 coordination may include requests for temporary suspension and
11 restrictions on elk hunting and harvesting while the study is being
12 conducted.

13 SECTION 2. This act shall become effective July 1, 2026.

14 SECTION 3. It being immediately necessary for the preservation
15 of the public peace, health or safety, an emergency is hereby
16 declared to exist, by reason whereof this act shall take effect and
17 be in full force from and after its passage and approval.

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19 COMMITTEE REPORT BY: COMMITTEE ON ENERGY AND NATURAL RESOURCES
20 OVERSIGHT, dated 04/13/2026 - DO PASS.
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